
HS 112: Japanese Language Class I

Course Code	HS 112
Course Name	Japanese Language Class I
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Intended for	UG/PG/Ph.D
Approval	62nd BoA (Jan 2026)

Preamble

This course introduces students to the Japanese language, and helps students to acquire Japanese grammar, characters and vocabulary, and to develop multiple skills such as listening, reading, writing and speaking comprehensively.

After taking this course, you will be able to

- Understand and use familiar everyday expressions and basic phrase.
- Introduce yourself and others.
- Ask and answer questions about personal details.
- Interact slowly and simply.
- Read Japanese characters (hiragana, katakana, and some basic kanji).
- Learn JLPT N5 level grammar and vocabulary.
- Cultivate intercultural understanding
- Develop a deeper understanding of the Japanese culture and your own culture by comparing and contrasting them with each other.

Course Modules

Classes are conducted according to the textbook 'Marugoto'.

Marugoto focuses on communication using Japanese and consists of scene syllabus. It systematically introduces the sentence patterns, grammar, vocabulary and kanji step by step showing every situation where these things are actually used.

Each lesson provides opportunities to read sentences, understand grammar, practice pronunciation and speaking, solve listening comprehension questions and sometimes write sentences in Japanese.

About 50 kanji characters are introduced, and worksheets are provided separately in class to assist learning.

The course also includes a number of questions that offer an opportunity to understand Japanese culture and can be discussed with learners in class.

The textbook Minna no Nihongo and its supplementary materials are also used as part of the main textbook as appropriate.

Homework assignments are given as appropriate to supplement the study content.

[Time of lectures]

- The first session is Introduction (1 hour).
- Lessons 1 to 6 are scheduled for three hours each, with the lecture of two types of characters. (18 hours)
- Lessons 7 to 16 are scheduled for two hours each. (20 hours)
- Exams (or assignments) are given in the middle and at the end of the semester. (3 hours)

(Total of 42 hours planned.)

[Title and Contents of lectures]

- **Lesson 1 – Hello:** Exchange greetings
- **Lesson 2 – Would you say that again?:** Use basic classroom expressions
- **Lesson 3 – Nice to meet you:** Give a simple self introduction
- **Lesson 4 – There are three people in my family:** Talk briefly about your family
- **Lesson 5 – What kind of food do you like?:** Talk about your favorite foods
- **Lesson 6 – Where are you going to have lunch today?:** Say what your favorite dish is
- **Lesson 7 – There are three rooms in my home:** Say what kind of home you live in
- **Lesson 8 – It's a nice room:** Ask/Say where to put things in the room
- **Lesson 9 – What time do you get up?:** Say the time you do something
- **Lesson 10 – When is convenient for you?:** Talk about your schedule for this week
- **Lesson 11 – What's your hobby?:** Talk about your hobbies
- **Lesson 12 – Shall we go together?:** Recognize information on posters and calendars for events
- **Lesson 13 – How are you going to get there?:** Recognize station and taxi signs
- **Lesson 14 – It's a famous temple:** Say how to get to a destination
- **Lesson 15 – Cute!:** Talk about what you want to buy
- **Lesson 16 – I'll take this:** Make a brief comment on things in a shop

Text Books

1. The Japan Foundation, *MARUGOTO: Japanese language and culture Starter A1 Coursebook*, SANSYUSYA, Japan, 2013
2. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2012
3. Yukiko Ogata, *Nihongo Fun & Easy: Survival Japanese Conversation for Beginners*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2009
4. Yoji Yamakuse, Michael A. Coony, *Heart & Soul of the Japanese*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2023

References

1. Atusko Tokui, *Tabunka kyousei no Komyunike-shon: Nihongo kyouiku no genba kara*, ALC Publishing, Japan, 2020
2. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N5 Tango 1000 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2017
3. Erin Meyer, *THE CULTURE MAP*, Public Affairs, US, 2016
4. Kiyomi Ogawa, Orrin Cummins, *YASANICHI MANGA JAPAN GUIDE*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2022
5. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N5 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
6. MARUGOTO Plus (Online) <https://marugotoweb.jp/ja/index.php>
7. The Japan Foundation, *IRODORI-Japanese for Life in Japan-*, The Japan Foundation, Japan, 2020
8. TSUNAHIRO (Online) <https://tsunagarujp.mext.go.jp/>